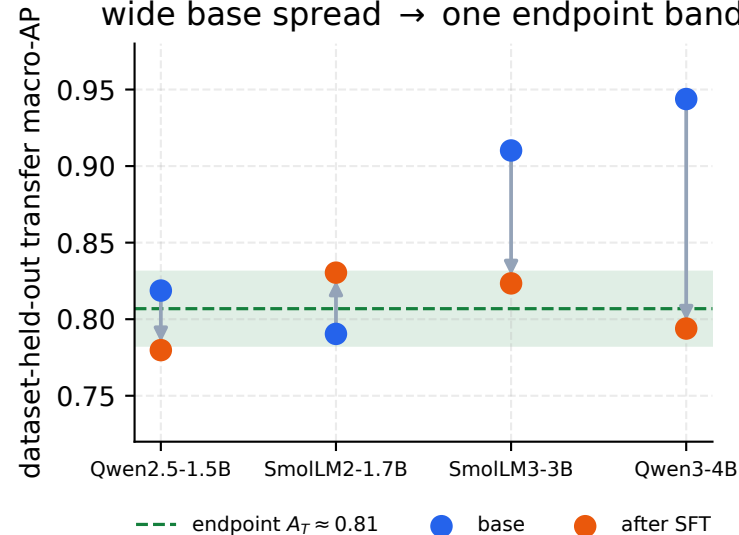


Act I, restated: after SFT the benchmark fixes the score; the checkpoint sets only the residual

Fine-tuning is an attractor:
wide base spread $\rightarrow$ one endpoint band



So “stronger base specializes more”
is arithmetic (fit slope -1.05 , $R^2 = 0.91$)

